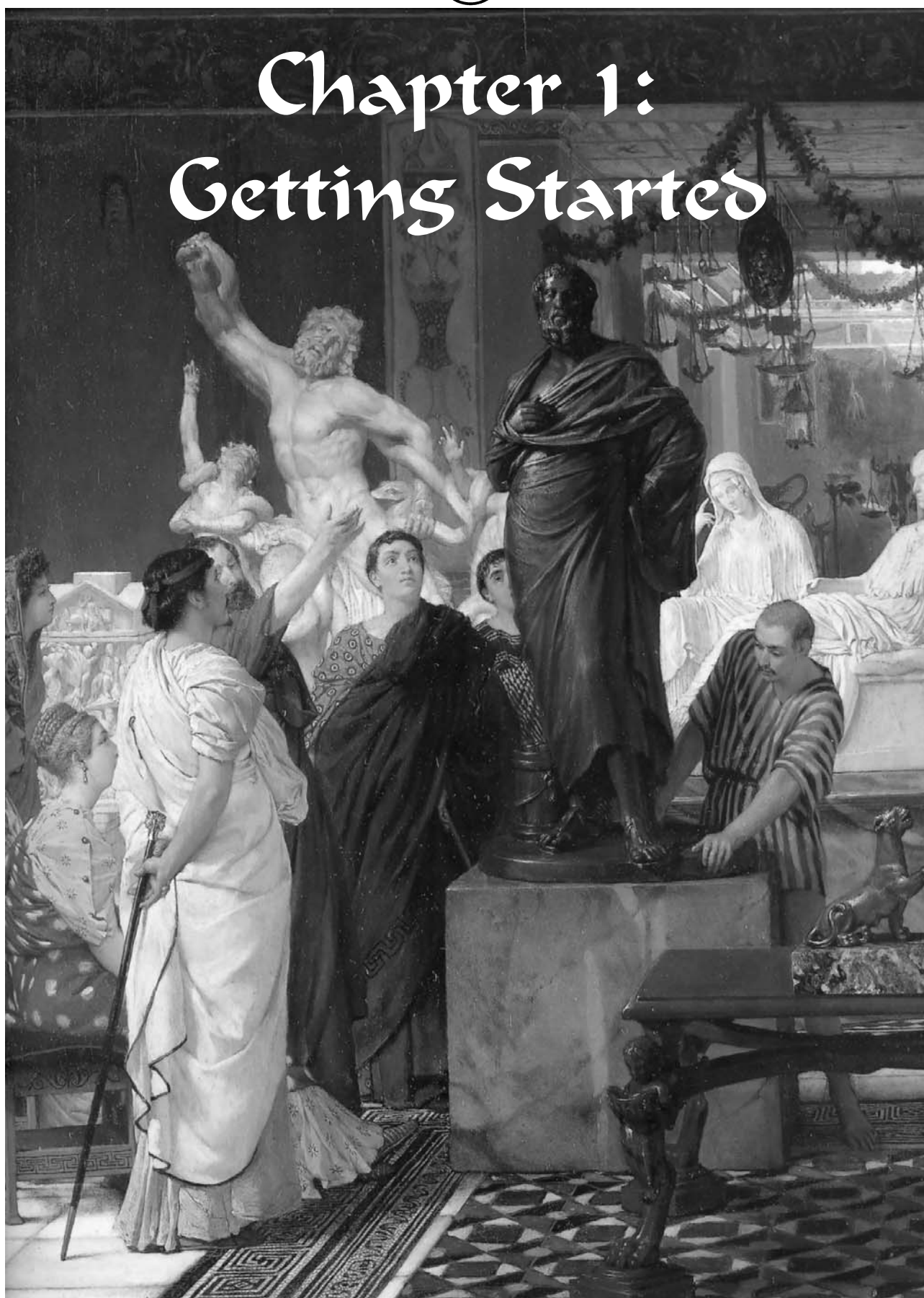




Chapter 1: Getting Started



ECLIPSE: THE CODEX PERSONA





System Introduction

Point-based design allows endless versatility, adding options for both games and characters. Here you'll find exotic techniques for warriors, skill options for experts and rogues, strange new abilities for divine spellcasters and exotic magical techniques for arcanists along with whole new forms of magic and might.

Of course, with unlimited options, the first thing to do is to start hacking away the ones you don't need.

GM's can use the handy worksheet in the back.

Each player needs to describe their character's class. While this description doesn't need to be very long or complicated, it should cover the basics of WHAT a character does and HOW he or she does it. We suggest three to four sentences, although sometimes a simple, iconic name suffices. Either way, you need to set down what the character's strengths are. For example:

"Randir the Witch-Hunter has dedicated himself to hunting and defeating rogue spellcasters. He has a solid base in combat, though not exceptional, and has studied counter-magic. He knows how to sneak around, how to investigate - and how to cut an Wizard's throat."

Result: Randir can be expected to buy a fair number of levels in Warcraft (a.k.a., Base Attack Bonus) and fair hit dice. While resembling a classic Rogue, he has fewer skills, spending CP on defensive magical talents instead. Randir won't be taking many strange innate powers or major spellcasting, but may purchase some abilities Specialized against mages.

Don't be this guy!

Bill "So, what do you want to play, Mike?"

Mike: "I'm going to play Volthar the Barbarian!"

Bill: "OK, what kind of class description do you have?"

Mike: "He's... a barbarian?"

Bill: *Sigh*

Better... *"Volthar is a Barbarian's barbarian, a brutal destroyer who smashes people, places, and things. For him, it's not about the treasure, it's about defending the honor of his ancient people by killing everything in his path and taking their stuff, if any. As a tribal barbarian, he is well equipped for survival in his wasteland home."*

Result: Well, Barbarians are as Barbarians do. Even without using the standard build, Volthar will probably want a high combat skill, hit points, and probably the Berserker abilities. With a bit more detail he could have gone in for some totemistic magic or wilderness skills, assuming he wanted any.

Of course, both of those characters could be built more or less conventionally. Other players will get more creative. This book is pretty much designed for them.

There are others: the Wolf-Binder, The Shamanistic "Lady of Many Spirits," The Trickster, The Thunderer, The Mistress of Life and Fire, and the Lightbringer. Each has their own task, and endures across the ages.

Ulric is the Wanderer. It is his duty to maintain the ancient wards and to fulfill the mysterious dictates of Wyrdr. He does not know his age. He knows that he was born in the far north, where he was called to battle a spirit of winter that sought to engulf the world, but there are centuries' worth of gaps in his memory and his power. He is a skillful physician-scholar, staff-fighter, and dabbles in alchemical magic, but most of his power is derived from the immortal fires of the Path of the Dragon which burn within him.

Still, there are many who would open the gates of the world and unleash what waits beyond. Until he regains his full might, it will be necessary to conceal himself from them.

Result: Well, Ulric is obviously going to be tough, have quite a few innate magical abilities, some skills, and some specialized combat and spellcasting. Probably the player has a power build in mind; specializing some of his talents will let him squeeze out a few extra points - but since he intends to conceal some of his powers, and is providing plenty of free plot hooks, that shouldn't be a problem. At least this player really has something definite in mind. For a writeup, see page 165.

Want a noble hero tormented by the dark powers of a demon imprisoned in him? A merchant prince? A fallen godling out to reclaim his throne? A renegade cyborg? A social manipulator? An inventor?

Go right ahead.

Characters still may "multiclass," only it revolves around taking abilities outside their descriptions. Some GM's may prefer that characters take levels from a standard list of classes, in which case they should simply select lists of abilities to suit their world and use the normal d20 multiclassing rules. The Dabbler penalty (page 17) and the Schooling ability (page 42) may apply.

Remember that "I'm Playing In Character!" does NOT excuse being disruptive or demanding extra work from the GM. You're the one who came up with the character to begin with: it's your job to make him or her acceptable to the group and to keep him or her involved with it. Characters who will not work with the group will be, quite rightly, abandoned by it. From the characters' points of view "PC" and "NPC" are quite identical. If your character is interfering with other people's ability to play, invent a reason for him or her to grow, change, or get along - or take him or her away.



Character Building Basics

The character building system revolves around CP, or character points. Everything is bought with them, including skills, feats, and hit dice. Every character receives 24 CP, to spend on upgrades per level.

Instead of gaining bonus feats at levels 1, 3, 6, 9, 12, 15, and 18, characters gain +6 CP. In any case, this bonus represents things the character has picked up through experience, rather than through training. They can be used for pretty much anything, regardless of a character's speciality, concept, or framework limitations (page 16).

Instead of gaining the usual attribute boost at levels 4, 8, 12, 16, and 20, characters gain Improved Self-Development. This raises low attributes more than high ones but otherwise works much the same way. See page 42 for more information about Self-Development.

You may prefer to give epic-level characters fewer - perhaps 12 - CP per level on the grounds that (1) they've already seen almost everything, (2) they have to spend most of their time keeping in practice with their current abilities, and (3) that they're already about as powerful as mortals get. For reference purposes, most epic level feats cost about 12 CP to build.

Children, Growth, and Adventurers Table

Level	Hit Points	Life Stage	CP and SP gained
"-2"	1	Infant	None. Helpless.
"-1"	1 +Con Mod	Child	+2x(Int Mod) SP
0	3 +Con Mod	Youth	+24 CP +Int Mod SP
1	Hit Die Max + Con Mod	Adult	+24 CP +Int Mod SP
+1	Hit Die + Con Mod	Adult	+24 CP +Int Mod SP

Most Game Masters start characters off at level one, under the assumption that they're successfully gotten through childhood and adolescence. While exceptional children may gain levels before adulthood, it's relatively rare. If it happens just move on up the chart.

Basic Expenditures

Hit Dice. While characters receive basic hits (1d4 + Con modifier) for each level, they may buy larger hit dice. Upgrading to a d6 costs 2 CP, a d8 costs 4, a d10 costs 6, a d12 costs 8, and a full d20 costs 16, if your GM will allow you to take them. (These cost a number of CP equal to the hit die's die type, minus 4.) Characters

who wish to become extremely tough may purchase a second hit die at any level for 8 CP + the normal die type cost listed above. Characters do gain their Con modifier again for the second die.



Is there something wrong with being a stereotype?

Skills. 1 CP buys 1 skill point. The normal maximum (Level + 3) for skill ranks remain unchanged. Any cross-class (we call it "irrelevant") skill on which a player spends 6 or more CP becomes a class skill ("relevant") from then on. What skills start off in-class are designated by the GM in consultation with the player according to the class description. Most classes start off with 12-18 class skills, but skill-based characters often have more.

- Characters gain bonus SP for high Intelligence, as listed on the *Children, Growth, and Adventurers* table above.

- Characters may buy a "specialty" in a given skill for 1 CP; these add +3 to the roll, but only for a chosen limited application. Only one specialty ever applies at a single time, even if they overlap. For example, many riders specialize in "Horses."

- Unlike normal skills, restricted skills can't normally become "relevant" without the Occult Skill (Improved) feat. A restricted skill is simply a skill that most people can't learn, usually because it's highly specialized, requires secret lore, or has exotic prerequisites. The 3.0 Rogue's *Read Lips* skill was restricted, even if that didn't make much sense. There are better examples on page 39.

General Skill Options

- Roll skill and attribute checks using 3d6 instead of 1d20. Since this gives much more consistent results, averaging around 10, it makes skill ranks and modifiers much more important.
- Use “Familiarities.” An untrained character takes a -4 penalty on skill checks. This can be eliminated by either taking levels in the skill or by becoming familiar with the skill; you can become familiar with 3 separate skills per skill point invested. Skill enhancing devices do NOT negate unfamiliarity penalties.
- Allow characters to spend CP and Int-based SP from their next level in advance provided that the character actually takes the time to learn a skill or skills in-game.
- Give every character some automatic skills at level one. These normally include: Profession or Craft (whatever your parents did) +2, and specialties in Sense Motive (own culture), Handle Animal (those commonly used in your culture), Knowledge: Local Area (where you grew up), and Knowledge: (your) Religion. Familiarities include: Bluff, Diplomacy Gather Information, Hide, Listen, and Climb. For comparison, this would have a total cost of 8 SP.

Creatures with distinctly different homelands or physiologies should substitute something else for these skills as appropriate. Monks raised in seclusion may not have Profession or Craft. Centaurs won't have Climb.

Specific Knowledges

Specific Knowledges are straightforward; instead of spending skill points on general information - such as Knowledge: Geography - you spend them on specific things, such as “The defenses and layout of Castle Eravain.” In general, this can be treated as a +15 bonus on relevant rolls. Of course, knowing exactly what some authority has to say on a subject is only helpful if they happen to be right.

Common types of specific knowledge include:

- Books normally cost 1-3 SP each. They're a good deal harder to remember than poems and such. Quite a few priests commit one or more major holy books to memory, normally at a reduced cost of 1 SP each due to their dedication.
- Epic Poems and Classic Ballads are designed to be easily memorized, but are often very long. It costs 1 SP to memorize three of them.
- Individual Studies are difficult to classify. In general they can be treated as “memorizing a book” on the subject in question.
- Mystical Rituals depend on their complexity. In general, you can memorize (Int Mod +3) minor rituals (burial, marriage, coming of age, etc) for 1 SP. Major rituals with notable effects will probably cost 1 SP each. Sadly, while memorizing a ritual provides the usual +15 bonus on knowledge checks about said rite, it only offers a +5 bonus on actually performing the ritual.

- True Names are difficult to discover, learn, and pronounce. Once found, you can memorize one major (sentient beings, mystical entities, elements or forces), three lesser (animal types such as “Hyena,” common items, and organs), or twelve minor (plant types, e.g., “Basil”) names per skill point. Knowing something's True Name is usually worth a +4 bonus on any rolls involving using magic against it. Other uses are possible, but depend on the game world and the creature involved.

Saving Throws. Each point of bonus in a single saving throw (Fort, Ref, Will) costs 3 CP. They can be modified and limited to make them cheaper, but more specific. See *Resist* on page 41 for more information.

Special Abilities. Characters may purchase feats and special abilities. Most cost 6 CP, but some have varying costs, or cost more or less than usual. See the *Abilities* section (the abilities section starts on page 23) for more details. Abilities can be modified and limited to make them cheaper, but less effective.

- GM's must approve any Corrupted or Specialized ability (page 22). Remember, if it doesn't hinder the character, it isn't a downside. All class features are available as feats or a combination of feats.

Proficiencies. These fall under abilities, and are located on page 49.

BAB. Base Attack Bonus is purchased as Warcraft. Each level of Warcraft costs 6 CP and adds +1 to the character's Base Attack Bonus. It may be taken multiple times, up to three points over the character's level, just like a skill. This is the only attack-bonus purchase which contributes to the character's attack progression. Other, special-purpose enhancements exist for players to buy, of course.

Base Caster Level works like Base Attack Bonus and has the same cost and cap; 6 CP per level up to a limit of +3 over the character's level. Basic spellcasters have a Specialized (only for the progression it was purchased with, 3 CP/level) version of this included with the cost of their Caster Levels. Paladin and Ranger progressions are an exception: since they have an effective Caster Level equal to their (class level/2), they need only buy 10 Specialized Caster Levels, totaling 30 CP at level 20. The cost of spell slots varies with the progression, as shown under Magic Levels, below. Magic levels which apply to two or three progressions are usually considered Corrupted, and cost 4 CP each - making it slightly cheaper to combine spellcasting progressions.

Casting a spell or using a power normally requires a minimum Caster Level equal to (twice its level -1). The Game Master may or may not enforce this. If not, it may be possible to cast very powerful spells with very low Caster Levels and spells with fixed, rather than per-level, effects become far more valuable.

Magic Levels. Characters usually purchase spellcasting abilities level by level, although alternative systems exist for those who wish to use them (see Chapter 3, page 65). Characters may not buy more than two magic levels in any one progression per level, and cannot buy a magic level higher than their (character level + 3) in any case. See also *Base Caster Level*, above.

Progression	Cost
Paladin or Ranger	2
Psychic Warrior, Wilder, Adept	6*
Bard, Cleric (No Package), Druid	8*
Cleric Package	10*
Psion	12*
Wizard	14*
Sorcerer	16*

**Includes +1 Specialized Caster Level.*

All magic levels are normally subject to at least two of the following limitations:

- **Components.** Spellcasting requires extensive work, including incantations, gestures, and weird material components. Most effects are subject to armor-related spell failure and cannot be used without pouches full of spell materials. Arcane magic is usually subject to this restriction.
- **Conduct.** The user must subscribe to specific beliefs, behave in particular ways, or live up to various duties



But she can so Read Magic!

ECLIPSE: THE CODEX PERSONA

and obligations, for his or her spells to work. This usually applies to Divine magic, though some ascetic Psionic or Arcane forms have this.

• **Noncombative** (3.5 Optional). The user's spell list has either very limited or virtually no combat applications. The only standard classes using this modifier are the 3.5 Ranger and Bard; the 3.0 versions started with relatively limited combat magic, but were free to develop it. The 3.5 versions may not.

• **Restrained.** The user can only produce a limited range of effects - typically "no wide-area destructive spells," although many other limitations are possible. Divine and Psionic powers are usually subject to this.

• **Studies.** Spells must be found and mastered, or the user is limited to a modest list of inherent spells (and can only trade around one per level). Arcane and Psionic powers are usually subject to this restriction. Sadly, only those using Inherent Spells can be spontaneous casters.

Removing a limitation adds +2 points to the cost of each magic level. Extra ones reduce the per-level cost by -1 point for every six points (or part thereof) of the cost on the chart above. For example, a "Prophet" might use the Sorcerer's charts (16 CP/level) - but use the Conduct restriction as well, reducing the cost to 13 CP/level. Sadly, spell progressions have a minimum cost of 2 CP/level regardless of how many limitations are applied and are always restricted to a general type of magic.

Beginning cleric magic is a considerable bargain. It normally includes two domains (12 CP), their related feats (12 CP), Spell Conversion (Healing OR Harming spells, 6 CP) and a set of specialty Spell Slots (6 CP). This is a sort of Divine Credit. It assumes that religion is going to be a major part of the character's career. The GM may opt to make dabblers buy these abilities separately. In this case, the per-level cost of cleric magic is reduced to 8, identical to the Druid's. This actually is a better buy at very high levels, starting at level 19.

To continue our first example, A Witch-Hunter probably has only the Paladin/Ranger progression, bought with the following limitations: Restrained (only counter-magic spells with a few healing and banishing spells) and Code of Conduct (user must not study other Arcane or primal magic). While bought as Arcane here, it could easily be bought as Divine for an order of holy guardians or Psionic for an elite order of meditative wardens. This will cost 2 CP/level and is usable in armor, but will never become very powerful.

Spells. Characters may acquire an existing spell formula of any spell they could cast but do not already know for 1 CP. Original, customized spells cost 2 CP. Casters who can use spells spontaneously pay double the normal cost. Characters using psionic abilities which may be augmented pay three times the normal cost. The "Spells known" category in the progressions (page 12-14) is only of interest to characters limited by Studies.

Spell Progressions

All spell progressions include the numbers of spells known for spontaneous sorcerer-style casters.

Paladin and Ranger Spell Progression

Spells gained per level/Spells known (if applicable)

Lv	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4	Lv	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4
1	1/2	0/1	-/-	-/-	-/-	11	3/5	2/4	1/3	1/2	0/1
2	1/3	0/1	-/-	-/-	-/-	12	3/5	2/4	1/3	1/2	1/1
3	2/3	1/2	-/-	-/-	-/-	13	3/5	2/4	2/3	1/3	1/1
4	3/3	1/2	-/-	-/-	-/-	14	3/5	2/4	2/4	2/3	1/2
5	3/3	1/2	0/-	-/-	-/-	15	3/6	3/4	2/4	2/3	1/2
6	3/4	1/2	0/1	-/-	-/-	16	3/6	3/5	3/4	3/4	2/2
7	3/4	1/3	1/1	-/-	-/-	17	3/6	3/5	3/5	3/4	3/3
8	3/4	1/3	1/1	0/1	-/-	18	4/6	4/5	3/5	3/4	3/3
9	3/4	1/3	1/2	1/1	-/-	19	4/6	4/5	4/5	4/5	3/3
10	3/5	2/3	1/2	1/2	-/-	20	4/6	4/5	4/5	4/5	4/4

Note that basic Paladins and Rangers start investing points in spellcasting at level 4.

3.0 Psychic Warrior Power Progression

Power Points and Powers

Level	Power Pts/Day	- Powers Discovered -	0	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	2	2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
2	3	3	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
3	4	3	1	—	—	—	—	—	—
4	5	3	2	—	—	—	—	—	—
5	8	3	3	1	—	—	—	—	—
6	11	3	3	2	—	—	—	—	—
7	16	3	3	2	1	—	—	—	—
8	21	3	3	3	1	—	—	—	—
9	26	3	3	3	2	—	—	—	—
10	33	3	3	3	2	1	—	—	—
11	40	3	3	3	3	1	—	—	—
12	47	3	3	3	3	2	—	—	—
13	56	3	3	3	3	2	1	—	—
14	65	3	3	3	3	3	1	—	—
15	74	3	3	3	3	3	2	—	—
16	85	3	3	3	3	3	2	1	—
17	96	3	3	3	3	3	3	1	—
18	107	3	3	3	3	3	3	2	—
19	118	3	4	3	3	3	3	2	—
20	129	3	4	3	3	3	3	3	—

3.0 Psionic Powers are a great deal more specific than the 3.5 powers. For example, the ability to summon Astral Constructs included nine separate disciplines in 3.0; these were folded into one in 3.5. The 3.0 charts thus offer substantially more powers. As a rule, the 3.0 chart should only be used with the 3.0 powers and the 3.5 chart with the 3.5 powers.

Characters who want to use psychic progressions for normal spellcasting should divide the listed Power by 1.8 to convert it to spell levels, and may trade out one old spell formula per level. Characters who want to use normal magic levels for psychic progressions should multiply the available spell levels by 1.8 to get Power, use the total number of spells known as the number of disciplines known, and use the maximum level of slot available as the maximum level of power which they can know.

3.5 Psychic Warrior Power Progression

Power Points and Powers

Lvl	Daily Power	Powers Known	Max	Lvl	Daily Power	Powers Known	Max
1	0	1	1 st	11	35	11	4 th
2	1	2	1 st	12	43	12	4 th
3	3	3	1 st	13	51	13	5 th
4	5	4	2 nd	14	59	14	5 th
5	7	5	2 nd	15	67	15	5 th
6	11	6	2 nd	16	79	16	6 th
7	15	7	3 rd	17	91	17	6 th
8	19	8	3 rd	18	103	18	6 th
9	23	9	3 rd	19	115	19	6 th
10	27	10	4 th	20	127	20	6 th

Wilder Power Progression

Power Points and Powers

Lv	Daily Power	Powers Known	Max	Lv	Daily Power	Powers Known	Max
1	2	1	1 st	11	106	6	5 th
2	6	2	1 st	12	126	7	6 th
3	11	2	1 st	13	147	7	6 th
4	17	3	2 nd	14	170	8	7 th
5	25	3	2 nd	15	195	8	7 th
6	35	4	3 rd	16	221	9	8 th
7	46	4	3 rd	17	250	9	8 th
8	58	5	4 th	18	280	10	9 th
9	72	5	4 th	19	311	10	9 th
10	88	6	5 th	20	343	11	9 th

Optionally, all chart-progression spellcasters have a "phantom slot" one level higher than their current maximum, representing whatever they're studying at the moment.

Unfortunately, using it requires a Fortitude save to avoid (1d4 damage per spell level), and a Will saving throw to avoid a spell misfire. Both DC's are (11+Spell Level).

Fooling around with magic you haven't yet mastered under stress is not recommended. Still, when did player-characters stick with what was recommended?



Like Spellcasters, Psionic characters get extra magic for having a high score in their primary magical attribute. In their case they receive (Att Mod) x Caster Level/2 extra Power rather than bonus spells.

Adept Spellcasting Progression

Spells gained per level/Spells known (if applicable)

Lv	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5
1	3/4	1/2	-	-	-	-
2	3/4	1/2	-	-	-	-
3	3/4	2/2	-	-	-	-
4	3/4	2/2	0/1	-	-	-
5	3/5	2/3	1/2	-	-	-
6	3/5	2/3	1/2	-	-	-
7	3/5	3/3	2/2	-	-	-
8	3/5	3/3	2/2	0/1	-	-
9	3/6	3/4	2/3	1/2	-	-
10	3/6	3/4	2/3	1/2	-	-
11	3/6	3/4	3/3	2/2	-	-
12	3/6	3/4	3/3	2/3	0/1	-
13	3/6	3/5	3/4	2/3	1/2	-
14	3/6	3/5	3/4	2/3	1/2	-
15	3/6	3/5	3/4	3/4	2/2	-
16	3/6	3/5	3/4	3/4	2/3	0/2
17	3/6	3/6	3/5	3/4	2/3	1/3
18	3/6	3/6	3/5	3/5	2/3	1/3
19	3/6	3/6	3/5	3/5	3/4	2/4
20	3/6	3/6	3/5	3/5	3/4	2/4

Bard Spellcasting Progression

Spells gained per level/Spells known (if applicable)

Lv	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6
1	2/4	-	-	-	-	-	-
2	3/5	0/2	-	-	-	-	-
3	3/6	1/3	-	-	-	-	-
4	3/6	2/3	0/2	-	-	-	-
5	3/6	3/4	1/3	-	-	-	-
6	3/6	3/4	2/3	-	-	-	-
7	3/6	3/4	2/4	0/2	-	-	-
8	3/6	3/4	3/4	1/3	-	-	-
9	3/6	3/4	3/4	2/3	-	-	-
10	3/6	3/4	3/4	2/4	0/2	-	-
11	3/6	3/4	3/4	3/4	1/3	-	-
12	3/6	3/4	3/4	3/4	2/3	-	-
13	3/6	3/4	3/4	3/4	2/4	0/2	-
14	4/6	3/4	3/4	3/4	3/4	1/3	-
15	4/6	4/4	3/4	3/4	3/4	2/3	-
16	4/6	4/5	4/4	3/4	3/4	2/4	0/2
17	4/6	4/5	4/5	4/4	3/4	3/4	1/3
18	4/6	4/5	4/5	4/5	4/4	3/4	2/3
19	4/6	4/5	4/5	4/5	4/5	4/4	3/4
20	4/6	4/5	4/5	4/5	4/5	4/5	4/4

Cleric and Druid Spellcasting Progression

Spells gained per level/Spells known (if applicable)

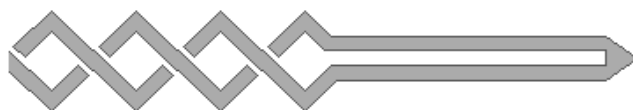
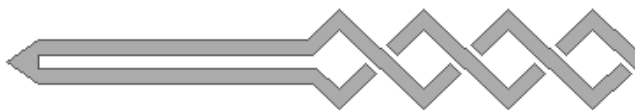
Lv	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7	L8	L9
1	3/5	1/3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2	4/6	2/3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
3	4/6	2/4	1/2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
4	5/7	3/4	2/3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
5	5/7	3/5	2/3	1/2	-	-	-	-	-	-
6	5/8	3/5	3/4	2/3	-	-	-	-	-	-
7	6/8	4/6	3/4	2/3	1/2	-	-	-	-	-
8	6/9	4/6	3/5	3/4	2/3	-	-	-	-	-
9	6/9	4/6	4/5	3/4	2/3	1/2	-	-	-	-
10	6/9	4/6	4/6	3/5	3/4	2/3	-	-	-	-
11	6/9	5/6	4/6	4/5	3/4	2/3	1/2	-	-	-
12	6/9	5/6	4/6	4/5	3/5	3/4	2/3	-	-	-
13	6/9	5/6	5/6	4/5	4/5	3/4	2/3	1/2	-	-
14	6/9	5/6	5/6	4/5	4/5	3/5	3/4	2/3	-	-
15	6/9	5/6	5/6	5/5	4/5	4/5	3/4	2/3	1/2	-
16	6/9	5/6	5/6	5/5	4/5	4/5	3/4	3/4	2/3	-
17	6/9	5/6	5/6	5/5	5/5	4/5	4/4	3/4	2/3	1/1
18	6/9	5/6	5/6	5/5	5/5	4/5	4/4	3/4	3/4	2/2
19	6/9	5/6	5/6	5/5	5/5	5/5	4/4	4/4	3/4	2/3
20	6/9	5/6	5/6	5/5	5/5	5/5	4/4	4/4	3/4	3/4

The clerical progression does not necessarily include domain spell slots. Those are gained via the Specialist ability (page 44).



The other Druids thought that the giant mouth tattoo was a bit much.

So it ate them.



3.0 Psion Power Progression

Power Points and Powers

Power		----- Powers Discovered -----									
Level	Pts/Day	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1	2	2	0	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2	3	2	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
3	4	2	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
4	7	3	2	0	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
5	10	3	2	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
6	15	4	2	1	0	-	-	-	-	-	-
7	20	4	3	2	1	-	-	-	-	-	-
8	27	5	3	2	1	0	-	-	-	-	-
9	34	5	3	2	2	1	-	-	-	-	-
10	43	6	3	2	2	1	0	-	-	-	-
11	52	6	3	3	2	2	1	-	-	-	-
12	63	7	3	3	2	2	1	0	-	-	-
13	74	7	4	3	3	2	2	1	-	-	-
14	87	7	4	3	3	2	2	1	0	-	-
15	100	7	4	3	3	3	2	2	1	-	-
16	115	7	4	4	3	3	2	2	1	0	-
17	130	7	4	4	3	3	3	2	2	1	-
18	147	7	4	4	4	3	3	2	2	1	0
19	164	7	4	4	4	3	3	3	2	1	1
20	183	7	4	4	4	4	3	3	2	2	1

3.0 Psions also gain one power of each level from their chosen speciality list. These become available at the "0" listings on the table.

3.0 Psionic Powers are a great deal more specific than the 3.5 powers. For example, the ability to summon Astral Constructs included nine separate disciplines in 3.0; these were folded into one in 3.5. The 3.0 charts thus offer substantially more powers. As a rule, the 3.0 chart should only be used with the 3.0 powers and the 3.5 chart with the 3.5 powers.

3.5 Psion Power Progression

Power Points and Powers

Daily Powers Max				Daily Powers Max			
Lvl	Power	Known	Lvl	Lvl	Power	Known	Lvl
1	2	3	1 st	11	106	22	6 th
2	6	5	1 st	12	126	24	6 th
3	11	7	2 nd	13	147	25	7 th
4	17	9	2 nd	14	170	27	7 th
5	25	11	3 rd	15	195	28	8 th
6	35	13	3 rd	16	221	30	8 th
7	46	15	4 th	17	250	31	9 th
8	58	17	4 th	18	280	33	9 th
9	72	19	5 th	19	311	34	9 th
10	88	21	5 th	20	343	36	9 th

Wizard Spellcasting Progression

Spells gained per level/Spells known (if applicable)

Lv	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7	L8	L9
1	3/8	1/6	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2	4/9	2/6	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
3	4/9	2/7	1/3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
4	4/10	3/7	2/4	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
5	4/10	3/8	2/4	1/3	-	-	-	-	-	-
6	4/11	3/8	3/5	2/4	-	-	-	-	-	-
7	4/11	4/9	3/5	2/4	1/3	-	-	-	-	-
8	4/12	4/9	3/6	3/5	2/4	-	-	-	-	-
9	4/12	4/9	4/6	3/5	2/4	1/3	-	-	-	-
10	4/12	4/9	4/7	3/6	3/5	2/4	-	-	-	-
11	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	3/5	2/4	1/3	-	-	-
12	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	3/6	3/5	2/4	-	-	-
13	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	3/5	2/4	1/2	-	-
14	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	3/6	3/5	2/3	-	-
15	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	4/6	3/5	2/4	1/2	-
16	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	4/6	3/5	3/4	2/3	-
17	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	4/6	4/5	3/4	2/3	1/2
18	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	4/6	4/5	3/4	3/4	2/3
19	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	4/6	4/5	4/4	3/4	2/3
20	4/12	4/9	4/7	4/6	4/6	4/6	4/5	4/4	4/4	4/4

Sorcerer Spellcasting Progression

Spells gained per level/Spells known (if applicable)

Lv	L0	L1	L2	L3	L4	L5	L6	L7	L8	L9
1	5/4	3/2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
2	6/5	4/2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
3	6/5	5/3	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
4	6/6	6/3	3/1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
5	6/6	6/4	4/2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
6	6/7	6/4	5/2	3/1	-	-	-	-	-	-
7	6/7	6/5	6/3	4/2	-	-	-	-	-	-
8	6/8	6/5	6/3	5/2	3/1	-	-	-	-	-
9	6/8	6/5	6/4	6/3	4/2	-	-	-	-	-
10	6/9	6/5	6/4	6/3	5/2	3/1	-	-	-	-
11	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/3	4/2	-	-	-	-
12	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/3	5/2	3/1	-	-	-
13	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/3	4/2	-	-	-
14	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/3	5/2	3/1	-	-
15	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/4	6/3	4/2	-	-
16	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/4	6/3	5/2	3/1	-
17	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/4	6/3	6/3	4/2	-
18	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/4	6/3	6/3	5/2	3/1
19	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/4	6/3	6/3	6/3	4/2
20	6/9	6/5	6/5	6/4	6/4	6/4	6/3	6/3	6/3	6/3

Corrupted and Specialized Magic

Corrupting or Specializing (page 22) magic levels allows for a great deal of variation over and above that inherent in mixing and matching limitations, levels, charts, and spell types. Either can be used to increase the effective number of magic ranks purchased, to reduce the cost, or alter the number of spells granted by each level. Some common modifications include:

- **Destructive.** Your magic has dangerous and/or destructive side effects, either environmental (usually Corrupted), on your friends (usually Specialized), or personal, such as insanity, progressive mania, damage, or spiritual corruption (usually Specialized).

While this is a classic for evil mages (who don't care what happens around them), a player character struggling with the undesirable consequences of power can be very interesting.

- **Difficult.** Your regain your magical energy slowly. This is usually Corrupted if it merely requires a week or two, or Specialized if you have to use Rite of Chi (page 42) or a similar ability to get it back.

This works well with characters who draw their magic from dangerous sources, steal it from mystical beings, or must pay for it in some fashion.

- **Elemental.** Your magic is restricted to an unusually narrow field. While "the four elements" (Corrupted) or a single element (Specialized) are common choices, there are hundreds of possible fields.

Almost too common to comment on, extreme specialization is usually better for dabblers than for magical experts.

- **Focused.** You need some vulnerable external device to use your magic. This is Corrupted if the "device" is something that's difficult to destroy or take away, such as a sacred grove, temple, or series of tattoos on your skin. It's Specialized if it's easily taken away, such as a staff or wand, or if it attracts trouble, such as a hidden horde of treasure.

Perhaps this is part of how dragons become so powerful - and why it angers them so much to have something stolen from their hordes. Heh.

- **Granted.** You deal with a single mystical entity on a personal level, and may acquire only those abilities which it decides to grant. This is Corrupted if it simply limits your choices, but Specialized if you have to debate

over your spells each day or if your patron keeps coming up with missions for you.

This is a classic for clerics and for spellcasters who are too impatient or greedy to actually study.

- **Mysticism.** Your magic relies on building up credit with various types of spirits, and so cannot use external power sources or batteries. This is usually Corrupted, but Specialized if the spirits are unusually difficult to please (i.e., you have a slow or difficult recovery).

This works well with Rune Magic (page 97), especially when combined with Mana (Specialized to create individual "pools" of favors with particular spirits, page 36) and Reflex Training (so that "spirits" can cast instant defensive spells for you, page 40).

- **Ritualist.** Your magic requires lengthy preparations and many components. This is usually Specialized unless normal magic is not available in a campaign.

The classic ritual summoner can command tremendous forces if he or she can keep summoned creatures around for a while with the Persistent metamagic (page 63), but is helpless if caught unprepared.

- **Subsumption.** You fuel your magic by "draining" power from others. This usually causes mental problems. This is Corrupted if you need steal powers only to learn them (i.e., to buy a power you must first defeat someone who has it) or Specialized if someone must be drained to regain your powers.

Less drastically characters can buy a progression to store but not cast spells, making them a walking magical battery. This Specialized power may require buying off some limitations such as Components or Studies.

- **Unreliable.** Your magic simply fails to work sometimes. This may require a die roll each time a spell is cast or there may be conditions that block your abilities, such as being on holy ground, carrying metal, or targeting someone carrying cold iron. Corrupted or Specialized depending on the extent of the limitation and how often it comes into play.

For a very Specialized version of this try magic which only works on a particular set of targets.

- **Wild.** Your magic is unstable. It may be governed by natural cycles, such as the phases of the moon, and thus be reasonably predictable (Corrupted) or it may vary randomly and/or have uncontrollable side effects (Specialized).

Note that this is a LIMITATION. It never improves your powers beyond what you've actually paid for, although it certainly reduces them at times.



It Slices! It Dices! It makes 31 varieties of Pancakes!

Control Mechanisms

While there's nothing wrong with a free-wheeling game that allows people to spend their CP on anything they want, it's hard to run.

Since *Eclipse* is designed for use in any setting, it offers far more character options than will fit into any one game world. Sadly, such flexibility, like any point-buy system, also allows many forms of character-design abuse. Players may want to indulge in truly grotesque min-maxing, create incredibly powerful specialists, take points for irrelevant "disadvantages" (or even disguised advantages), build characters that don't fit into the game world, stack bonuses, and buy whatever they see as the most convenient, "best," or most cost-effective abilities whether they make sense for the character or not.

Unfortunately, any given option will be "abusive" in some worlds and with some GM's but not in or with others. Trying to address this within the rules themselves is a futile effort that simply creates more loopholes and endless special cases. Ergo, here are some ways to customize things for your particular world.

- **Bloodlines.** Many abilities can be learned, but others require some innate mystical talent. If you're not born with that special spark, such abilities are extremely difficult (e.g., require a *Wish*, *Miracle*, great quest, major mystical experience, or divine aid) or even impossible to acquire. Players may pick a limited list of restricted abilities for which their character has the necessary "spark" during character creation.

- **Ritual.** Some abilities require specific rituals or odd technological means to acquire. The ingredients, places, times, and procedures to follow are all likely to be more or less difficult to find or arrange. This method, like Secrets, below, has the side benefit of being a rich source of side-adventures.

- **Secrets.** The secrets of some abilities are guarded by ancient hermits, hidden orders, supernatural beings, or elder dragons, are buried in rare manuscripts, or are only to be found in distant and dangerous places.

- **Training.** Some talents require months or years of exotic training, are very time-consuming to maintain, or have other special, or mutually exclusive, requirements. No one can have more than a few of them. As a side benefit, this option can be used to keep characters busy, and spending money, between adventures.

- **Development.** Some abilities take months or years to develop, may be erratic at first, and may cost more points than usual. Characters list the abilities they want and set aside points for them. The GM deducts points from that pool if and when he decides to make an ability available, may only allow a partial ability at first, and may deduct extra points for overly-useful abilities or combinations.

- **Approval.** This simple - if intrusive - method has the GM approve only a limited number of special abilities for each character. This is, of course, what most methods come down to in the end - but in this case we're not bothering with an in-game justification. This works, but it's less satisfying for everyone.

- **Framework.** Characters must spend a minimum number of points per level in various fields. This won't keep people from going for the "best" abilities, but it does force them to be tolerably well-rounded, cuts down on the number of special talents any one of them can have, and helps maintain the idea that they're learning from experience rather than picking from a menu. A basic Adventurer framework is shown below. While minor exceptions may be allowed, and points from bonus feats and disadvantages are not subject to the template limits, it should be suitable for most d20 settings.

Adventurer Framework

Per-Level Point Expenditure Restrictions

Ability	Minimum	Maximum
Hit Die	0*	None
Skill Points	2*	12
Saving Throws	3*	12
Special Abilities	0	12
Warcraft	3+	12
Magic Levels	0	18
Extra Spells	0	4

*More is usually a good idea

+This translates to a minimum BAB of (Level/2).

Most characters should be allowed to round down to the nearest 6.

Special Abilities. Individual Game Masters may make exceptions for heavily ability-dependent characters, such as Monks, but don't count on it. Adventurers may not invest more than (level+2) x 6 CP in any one chain of linked special abilities OR have more than (level+1) abilities from any one such chain. They cannot add more than two links to such a chain per level.

Proficiencies. Characters may spend as many CP as they wish on Proficiencies. As a practical matter, they are expected to learn at least four weapons; almost anyone should be able to pick up a club, crossbow, dagger, or staff and use it immediately. In fact, most adventurers should be able to use all simple weapons.

Magic Levels. No points need be spent here, but characters cannot gain more than two levels in any one magic progression per character level. Similarly, they may not buy more than 4 extra spells per character level.

Slight modifications to the basic framework can adapt it to particular campaigns. For example, in a modern espionage setting characters are presumably quite skilled, but can't have any mystical abilities beyond trivial psychic powers. Ergo:

Modern Espionage Framework: Minimum 6 CP per level spent on skills, maximum of 2 CP per level spent on mystical abilities.

In a setting where all the characters are a part of a mercenary company, one might reasonably require:

Elite Mercenary Framework: Minimum of 2 CP per level spent on buying larger hit dice, minimum of 4 CP spent on skills per level, maximum magic level of (character level - 3). This will keep the characters reasonably tough, but drastically limits their spellcasting.



You want to add what? Don't you think it's just a bit late for that? You're down to 18 CP!

Per-Level CP Modifiers

If applied to a character, these modifiers add or subtract the listed CP value at every level, starting at level 1. Modifiers linked to a particular ability (such as Very Limited Spell List) require the character to invest a substantial number of points in that ability; 3 per level is good minimum. That's nearly 3 full levels at level 20!

Dabbler. (-2) A character with Dabbler either has no class description or insists on taking abilities outside of that theme. This penalty applies to each level until said character takes out time (several months) to retrain. GMO as to whether this or the 10% XP penalty applies.

Duties. (+2) A character with Duties has extensive obligations. These restrict his or her time and freedom of action, as well as draining his or her resources, but also mean getting a lot of practice or extra training. This typically includes Druids, Clerics, and Paladins. Ignoring your duties brings on various penalties. Strangely, this continues until the GM feels you have enough penalties to equal the points you got from Duties.

Fast Learner. (+1) Actually purchased as a feat for 6 CP, this ability grants extra CP as the character rises in level. Specialized versions are available and encouraged. No one may take Fast Learner more than once unless it's been built into a template, race, or class by the Game Master. For example, wizards have Fast Learner Specialized in acquiring new spells each level. This doubles the CP output; each spell costs 1 CP, so wizards gain 2 spells per level.

The Game Master should keep a careful eye on Fast Learner; it is very easily abused.

Restrictions. (+1) A character with restrictions has major limitations on the use of some ability or type of equipment. He or she may *never* (ever!) acquire or use such talents without major penalties. For example, Witch-Hunters never cast spells except to fix

the problems caused by other magic on pain of losing most of their abilities.

The point bonus is per category which applies. A character only gains the bonus points for restrictions on things that would obviously useful to him or her. Common restrictions include wearing no armor, using no weapons, using no magic or psionics, or skill-related feats. A good explanation is in order. Why is the character restricted in this way?

Untrained. (-6) This character has not been trained as an "adventurer," is hopelessly untalented, or simply isn't interested. This modifier goes away - and the character gets to spend those CP - when he or she gets trained, starts to take an interest, or finds a talent (if any).

Very Limited Spell List. (+.5) The character's spell lists are unusually specialized, or otherwise restricted, for his or her magic style and class. The Paladin doesn't receive this, because his or her spell list covers nearly anything he or she might want to do and even offers some unique and powerful spells. Rangers, on the other hand, don't have nearly the versatility they arguably should get, so they receive this small bonus.

NPC Levels

How many levels should NPC's get? If it matters, we recommend the following chart for non-adventuring NPC's and for those for whom "adventures" are the rare exception, not the rule.

- Level 1 for being a mature adult
- +1 per age category (middle-aged, old, and venerable)
- +1/2/3/4/5/6/7/8 for raising at least 1/2/4/8/16/32/64/128 or more children to adulthood. *Max*
- +1 per social or guild rank climbed +4
- +1 for being knighted or publicly honored +2
- +1 for being ennobled or getting a major post +2
- +2 for being or becoming a ruler +4
- +2 for being worshiped as a god +2
- +2 for actually becoming a god +2

While the rules are exactly the same for adventurers and non-adventurers, or for NPC's and PC's, most non-adventurers invest their CP in things they actually use a lot rather than in anything the players or Game Master are likely to care about, or even notice.

Monster levels, of course, are whatever fits the story and the needs of the Game Master.

Once-Off CP Bonuses

These apply only once, although the CP bonus is permanent unless the character chooses to buy off a disadvantage.

Package Deals. Some groups offer a set (usually 6-12 CP worth) of abilities to anyone who joins up - and takes on their enemies and problems. This is a GM bribe to get characters to take on particular roles and obligations in the setting. If they're available, go ahead and take one; you'll be playing in the setting anyway.

Retraining. This allows a character to regain CP lost due to being Untrained or changing classes. It may also be used to eliminate limitations and Disadvantages, but character must pay off the bonus points derived from them first. Retraining usually requires 2d6 months and an in-game explanation of who, how, and where.

Unique Training. Popular with high-level characters, this can come from ancient masters, divine or infernal tutors, or simply spending six months disguised as a smith. It adds +1d6 CP, up to a maximum of +(2 x Intelligence) CP over a character's lifetime. Of course, only the GM may decide what qualifies as "unique training."

Disadvantages. Each character may take 1/2/3 disadvantages, for a total of +3/+6/+10 CP when the character is designed. Characters may not take more than three disadvantages. While this is not strictly reasonable - it would make more sense to have fewer CP since they must deal with their disability - it's more fun this way. Most ordinary character disadvantages can be found on the list below. If someone wants to get really creative, let them. It's only three or four points.

Disadvantages List

All disadvantages are subject to a general rule: if it doesn't cause you significant problems, then it's not a disadvantage, and is worth no points.

Accursed. The universe is out to get you. This covers literal curses, such as dooming those you love, terrible fates, bleeding fire instead of blood, or uncontrollable lycanthropy, as well as lesser, persistent annoyances. The latter might include being a preferred target for attacks (you count as two people if random targeting is used), unpleasant disabilities such as epilepsy, allergies and so on. Your curse can be lifted, but it requires a great deal of work or truly major magic.

Aged. You didn't take up adventuring until late in life. You are middle-aged or older and may, at the option of the GM, have an extra level or two with the points assigned to abilities of little use in adventuring - giving you a starting edge at the cost of a long-term penalty.

Blocked. You cannot use some type of ability to which you'd normally have access. This is commonly a magical school, but this may include racial abilities or class abilities in games which use classes.

Broke. You start with only a third of the usual cash and equipment you would be entitled to by your level. You may have continuing money problems as well if you add Obligations, Compulsive, or a similar flaw.

Compulsive. You have some particular mania or "code of conduct" which influences everything you do. Likely compulsions include the classic manias (like Pyro- or Klepto-), an overwhelming love or hatred, greed, dedication to some peculiar goal, truthfulness, extravagant spending, or even virtue. Codes include things like Hippocratic Oaths or Chivalry. Characters that ignore their compulsions take a 20% experience penalty.

Dependent. There is something you just have to have to function effectively. You could be addicted to a drug, rely on a special talisman, require constant support and encouragement, or simply be so confused that you need someone to tell you what to do. Unless there's a specific effect involved this defaults to a -3 penalty on your rolls.



Foolish. You don't learn as quickly as usual, and so take a 20% experience point penalty. This isn't, however, cumulative with the usual penalty for multiclassing.

Frail. You must make a (DC 18) Fortitude save after casting a spell of level 3+ or fighting for three rounds. On a failure you take 1d6 points of nonlethal damage and become staggered for 1d4 rounds. The GM may allow this to be limited to spellcasting OR combat, but this increases the save DC to 23.

Hallucinations, Flashbacks, and Visions. Your version of reality doesn't always agree with that of those about you. While this is common enough with respect to details, in your case it may extend to things like whether it's daytime. More commonly, and most dangerously, you may simply see a distorted version of what everyone else sees. This is up to the GM, but the occasional Will save (DC 18) is suggested, or you may react in a radically different manner than those about you.

Healing Resistant. You get only half the benefit of *Cure Wounds* or *Heal* spells. Additionally, *Neutralize* and *Remove* spells grant you a save to throw off whichever effect they are targeting, but aren't automatic. This does have an upside; the relevant *InFLICT Wounds*, *Harm*, *Contagion*, *Poison*, and *Blindness/Deafness* spells are similarly reduced in effectiveness, allowing an extra save or halving the effect.

History. The player has a few pages of notes for the GM about the character's history, personality, and goals. This should include some mention of friends and family, old enemies or allies, and where the character got his or her training or equipment. The GM should to allow the player several sessions to come up with it all.

Hunted. Someone's out to get you. You may be an outlaw, have personal enemies, or have been marked by some mystical entity. The nature of your foes should be decided in consultation with the GM. As a rule, you cannot simply confront your hunters and fight it out with them. They're either numerous, powerful, or secretive.

Illiterate. An Illiterate character either cannot read or write one language or all of the languages he or she knows. This disadvantage has a flat cost and does not refer back to the starting disadvantages price table. The character gains +1 CP for the lone language version or +2 CP for all languages. As a side note, this doesn't count against the maximum disadvantage limit, since it's only here to be consistent with the standard "barbarian" listing. In some settings the Game Master may choose to make illiteracy the default for most characters.

Incompetent. You suffer from a "-5" modifier on one GM-selected skill, or a "-3" modifier on a group of related skills (e.g., anything "high-tech").

Inept (select Int, Wis, Chr, or Dex). You suffer from a -2 modifier on all skills linked to the chosen attribute.

Insane. You're out of your mind. This is usually limited to particular situations or subjects, leaving you sane enough most of the time, but when that trigger comes up you become completely irrational. This most commonly shows up as phobias (darkness or a class of creature are favorites), but there are innumerable ways to go a little off your rocker.

Irreverent. You are fundamentally unable to accept the "divinity" of gods. You recognize their might and may even see one as a patron, but worship just isn't a part of your nature; they're just really powerful people to you. While gods generally forego directly smiting you, none of them will grant you divine magic and many clerics have a problem with you.

Obligations. You have responsibilities which you can not easily discharge. You may have dependents, debts, a geas, massive tithes, oaths to fulfill, a job which you cannot readily leave, be sworn to the service of a lord or ruler, or just have friends who need looking after. This is a wonderful way to get dragged into adventures.

Outcast. You are socially unacceptable in a large area or with a large and important group. You might be noted as an oathbreaker, an "untouchable," a kinslayer, or an ex-slave, belong to a despised ethnic group, believe in a heretical faith, or simply have numerous obnoxious habits. In any case, a sizable segment of the people in the campaign setting will have nothing to do with you.

Poor Reputation. You're widely and unfavorably known. This results in a -6 penalty on "friendly" social skill and Charisma rolls throughout a major portion of the setting. This may be combined with "Outcast," in which case there's not much use in trying to talk to anybody. Even your companions will suffer penalties if it becomes known that they associate with you.

Recorder. The player keeps records, and ensures that the GM gets a copy. Acceptable forms are up to the GM, but common variants include character diaries, letters, campaign logs, and keeping a list of NPC's.

Secret. There is something buried in your past which you must keep hidden. Your dark secret may range from your unpopular ancestry to being a mass murderer, but bad things happen if it is revealed (i.e., you will get two shiny new disadvantages). Characters most commonly get two from: Hunted, Outcast, Poor Reputation, or Valuable, but things like Accursed, Insane, Obligations, or Unluck may fit in some cases.





Showman. You compulsively posture, show off, gloat, and brag - giving away your plans and wasting time even in combat. You take a -3 Initiative penalty, while others get a +3 bonus on any checks that involve finding out what you're planning to do or are doing at the moment.

Slow. You suffer a -2 Initiative penalty and a -10 feet per round penalty to your base movement rate, and cannot buy feats which improve either of these.



The eternal dilemma: healthy baby versus extra CP. Heh.

Stigmata. You have some injury which either cannot be healed or has healed badly. It is both painful and inconvenient. You must make a DC 24 Fortitude save at the start of each session; if you fail you take a -1 morale penalty on saving throws for the duration of the session.

Unarmoured. You refuse to use armor for some reason. Characters who already suffer major penalties for wearing armor can't take this disadvantage.

Uncivilized. You do not fit into anything beyond a small tribe. Complex social situations, the sheer scale of cities and towns, and business and banking schemes (among other things) are all beyond your grasp. You stick out like a sore thumb in civilized areas and greatly prefer to stick with items, foods, and customs typical of your tribe. You start off with little or no access to advanced equipment or techniques for the setting, and often take a -4 penalty when dealing with civilized societies or technologies.

Unluck. Your life just keeps going wrong. You will be afflicted with many small miseries that have no game mechanic (the GM gets to screw with you). You always fail on a d20 roll of 2, regardless of how large your bonuses are, just as if you had rolled a natural 1.

Untrustworthy. You're hopelessly shift, have an odd aura, or just give the impression that you're guilty or up to something all the time. As a rule, nobody will take your word for anything, the local city guards tend to

blame anything that happens in the vicinity on you, and you'll have to pay in advance most of the time. Do not try to be the party spokesman. It just won't work out.

Valuable. You are worth a lot of money. This usually means that there's a reward out on you, but it may mean that you will bring a vast price on the slave market, have some mystic quality about you which makes you priceless to a mage, or, for truly exotic character races, that your body parts are extremely valuable.

Vows. While closely related to Compulsive, Vows are generally more restrictive. They're also far more dangerous; those who fail to live up to their vows face some form of retribution. On the other hand, they also get some support; characters gain a +/- 3 bonus (as needed) against attempts to make them break their vows.

Disadvantages are potentially far more trouble than they're worth. The GM shouldn't overstress them. They're most valuable to the game when used as a source of convenient plot hooks. Disadvantages may be bought off with CP if the GM agrees. Doing so without explanation costs twice the CP value. Doing so with a good in-game explanation (training or building up a new reputation) costs CP equal to the value. Doing so through some major in-game quest or epic adventure costs nothing. In any case, the GM must be consulted and must agree to any such changes. Disadvantages which are integral to the character, or have become major plot elements, normally cannot be removed.